



Citizenship for sale

Citizenships are now up for grabs as poorer countries looking for investments offer passports for a few thousand dollars
<http://dgit.in/BuyCitizen>

officially selling their audio gear in India via headphonezone. You now have both the Jabees - Shield (₹5,499) and the BTwins (₹7,999) for the taking. The BTwins in fact boast an iPX4 Sweat-proof Design and would work well for those health conscious geeks looking for truly wireless in-ears to accompany a rigorous workout routine.

This recent spate of going wireless makes me believe even more well established brands will soon take the plunge in this segment. One of the more encouraging announcements to this end was the official launch of the Beyerdynamic Byron series in India. Although to be fair, only the wired

Byron variant was affordable while the Byron BTA was still stratospheric at ₹15,350. Still, it's a start. I wouldn't be surprised if we soon get a wireless Sennheiser CX 180 and CX 275.

So far, my "go to" wireless companion has been the Jaybirds X2, which I've sort of indefinitely borrowed from a very generous Team Digit member (shhh... let's not make a big deal of it), but now that this high end Beyerdynamic wireless has launched, maybe I can steal myself an upgrade? Even if said Digit team member has wised up to my plans, I can always buy myself one of the more affordable options I've talked about above. Good times!

BUYING ADVICE

WHICH PHONE TO BUY?

Q As you know, from 1st July GST is going to be implemented. So my first question is – are mobile prices going to increase after that?

I am planning to buy a new mobile in next 2-3 days. Right now I am using Micromax Canvas 4 (A210) since last more than 4 years. Right now most of the mobiles support LTE and VoLTE while my current one supports only GSM. If my sim type is LTE + LTE and network type is (4G, 3G) and I have set the option "Network mode" in "Settings" as "Auto", it will not switch from 4G to 3G and 3G to 2G as required? Would I be able to video call over Whatsapp or Google-Duo calling using my Wi-Fi / mobile data? Must I have a VoLTE phone to do that?

I need to buy a phone under ₹20000 with at least 3GB RAM, 32 internal, and 3000 mAh battery

—Vishal Verma

A Going through all your requirements, I would recommend the Moto G5 Plus as the best phone for you. It fits all your needs. When Network Mode is set to auto, the phone automatically picks the best available connection. As long as 4G is available, it'll be at 4G. If not, it looks

for a 3G connection and failing that, goes to 2G. If nothing's available, you'll see the no signal message. Video or voice call over WhatsApp, Skype etc. are made using Voice over IP (VoIP). So you'll be able to do it over mobile data or WiFi. It does NOT depend on which network you're on. That said, signal strength, speed etc. can affect quality. VoLTE is not a network type, it stands for Voice over LTE. That should also answer your question about whether calls can be made over a 4G network. In short, yes they can, but your network provider must support that. So, Jio to Jio calls are made over a 4G network, while all others in India currently make calls over 3G network.

That said, these things are sort of backward compatible. So, if you're on a 4G network, it automatically switches to 3G/2G during a call. I recommend you read this story for more clarity: <http://dgit.in/ltevetc>

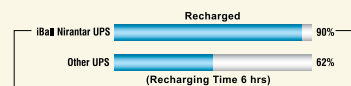
VoLTE itself is a feature. As I mentioned above, it stands for Voice over LTE and not every telco in India supports it yet. Phones (at least the ones from 2016-17) on the other hand do support VoLTE (including the Moto G5 Plus). The story I cited above should explain everything you need to know about VoLTE calling.



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